FORT SILENCE

A contained military thriller | Original feature | Prepared for Lifetime

NCCA ENTERTAINMENT
Atlanta, Georgia

LOGLINE

When an Army CID investigator probes a young private's apparent suicide at the Georgia post where her father died, she uncovers a lethal sleep-deprivation program and must expose the commander who raised her before the same system destroys its last witness.

FORMAT

Original feature. Movie event, approx. 88 minutes.

GENRE

Female-led psychological thriller with a military investigation engine.

SETTING

Fort Stewart and Hinesville, Georgia. Present day, with a 2006 prologue.

STATUS

Script complete, third draft. Available to read on request.

WHO SHE IS

Special Agent Jordan Hayes, 34. Army CID's best closer: forty cases, forty clean closures. Raised on Army posts, and raised after her father's death by the woman who now commands Fort Stewart.

WHAT THREATENS HER

The more Jordan uncovers, the more the post turns on her. Her credentials are pulled, her motel room is entered, her witness is taken, and her own exhaustion is used as proof that she is unstable.

WHY NO ONE CAN SAVE HER

The betrayal comes from inside her own family. Colonel Diane Mercer pins on her badges, cooks her dinner, and quietly builds a file saying Jordan is breaking down the way her father did.

WHAT SHE STANDS TO LOSE

Her career. A frightened 19-year-old witness. The only mother she has left. And the truth about her father, who died in the same building twenty years ago.

THE STORY

Sent to close the case of Private Tyler Vogel, found hanged in a barracks stairwell, Jordan finds things that don't fit the suicide ruling: a burn ring on his wrist, red clay on his bare feet, and tally marks on his locker counting seventy-one hours without sleep. The trail leads to Building 1147, a "resilience" program running recruits past seventy-two hours awake while a defense contractor collects the data. Three earlier deaths share the same burn. One of them is a case Jordan signed off on herself. Then, in a basement archive, she finds her father's real death report. Same building. Same burn. Signed by Mercer. Stripped of her badge and running on no sleep, Jordan can only win by doing what she has never done: trusting other people with the case. With a drill sergeant who was there in 2006, a records clerk willing to put his name on the evidence, and the private the system tried to bury, she brings the truth to a congressional hearing that was meant to crown Mercer's career.

WHY LIFETIME

- A woman's point of view from start to finish, with a betrayal by the person she trusts most.
- Every act raises the danger, isolates her further, and erodes her credibility.
- A smart, competent heroine who still gets cornered.
- The menace is personal. The villain is a mother figure, not a faceless institution.
- A strong lead role plus a commanding older female antagonist.

TRAILER MOMENTS

- A girl at a rainy funeral is told "It was fast."
- Red light leaking from a warehouse as barefoot recruits shuffle in at midnight.
- Jordan finds her own name on a case she closed too fast.
- Mercer slides her a bottle of sleeping pills: "I won't make that mistake twice."
- A private stands up at the hearing: "I'm the behavioral health care."

TONE AND COMPS

Army Wives for the post community and the women at its center. **Sleeping with the Enemy** for the intimate menace of someone who smiles while they control you. **The General's Daughter** for a military investigation that uncovers an institutional cover-up. Grounded and restrained: the violence is off screen, and the damage is emotional.

PRODUCTION PROFILE

Contained and Georgia-friendly. Most scenes take place in offices, barracks, a motel, a records basement, two homes, a diner and one hearing room. Exteriors include a parade field, a cemetery and a warehouse. No large stunts, and only one brief struggle. A manageable core cast of six leads.

THE TEAM

Kelly R. Tenney, writer and producer. Founder of NCCA Entertainment, Atlanta. More than 20 years in film and television, including Co-Producer on nine seasons of *One Tree Hill*. DGA and IATSE.

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Cast suggestions | Wish list for discussion

NCCA ENTERTAINMENT
Atlanta, Georgia

These are suggestions for discussion, chosen for each role's lane and for performers' fit with Lifetime audiences. **No one listed is attached, and no one has been approached. Availability and interest have not been checked.** Ages in the script can flex for the right actor.

ROLE	WHAT THE ROLE NEEDS	SUGGESTIONS
JORDAN HAYES Lead. 30s. CID special agent.	Has to carry stillness and composure while cracking underneath. Most of her performance is listening, waiting and holding it in.	Kiki Layne Teyonah Parris Jurnee Smollett
COL. DIANE MERCER Co-lead. 50s. Garrison commander.	Warmth and command in the same gesture. The audience should love her before they fear her. The marquee antagonist role.	Sanaa Lathan Vanessa Williams Mary McCormack
SFC ISAIAH BROOKS Lead. 40s. Drill sergeant.	Intimidating on the surface, devastatingly honest underneath. Twenty years of silence he's finally ready to break.	Omari Hardwick Mehcad Brooks Michael Ealy
PVT. CARLA RUIZ Lead. 19. Recruit and witness.	Fear and quick wit, with real stakes at home. A breakout role that ends with the movie's biggest standing-up moment.	Xochitl Gomez Isabela Merced Paulina Chávez
MAJ. TRENT OAKLEY Supporting. 40s. Program officer.	A runner's build and a politician's handshake. Charming menace who turns cowardly once he's cornered.	Jake Lacy Jake McDorman
DR. ALAN PRUITT Supporting. 50s. Defense contractor.	Clinical and calm, with a pediatrician's smile. Scariest when he's simply measuring someone.	Michael Kelly Josh Hamilton
DEL NAVARRO Supporting. 60. CID special agent in charge.	A worn-out procedural boss whose caution turns into accountability.	Esai Morales Benito Martinez
REP. RUTH CALLOWAY Supporting. 60s. Congresswoman.	Georgia warmth and steel, sharp enough to see through a prepared answer. Owns the hearing.	Lorraine Toussaint CCH Pounder
MS. ODELL Featured. 70s. Records civilian.	Twenty years of keeping a secret where she could find it again. A two-scene showcase.	Loretta Devine Jenifer Lewis
DONNA VOGEL Featured. 40s. Tyler's mother.	A nurse's precision in grief. Says "Do they get to bury him twice?"	Kelli Williams Jaime Ray Newman
SPC. DEVONTE PRICE Featured. 20s. Records clerk.	A cautious clerk who ends up putting his name on the truth.	Caleb McLaughlin

Casting strategy. Lead with a Jordan and Mercer pairing that sells the mother-daughter betrayal at a glance: one rising lead with a familiar, trusted face across from her. Brooks and Carla are the actor-bait roles that can bring a known name on a short schedule. The supporting roles are a handful of shooting days each and can be filled in Georgia.